APTOHIRE

Go-To-Market Strategy

Institution-first beachhead, pilot design, channels and measurable funnel

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Research note: distinguish sourced facts from estimates and strategic hypotheses. Market sizing below is a transparent planning model, not an independently verified market-revenue forecast.

1. Strategic thesis

Lead with institutions, prove student value and recruiter usefulness, then scale employer demand. A two-sided marketplace launched without a concentrated, verified talent cohort risks weak liquidity; a university-first pilot can create a defined cohort and a measurable operating partner.

2. Beachhead and ideal customer profile

ICP dimension	Initial hypothesis
Institution	Private university, university group or college with an active placement cell and leadership sponsor.
Cohort	One department or job family with enough students to evaluate completion and outcomes.
Use case	Skill-evidence pilot for internships / entry-level technical roles, plus placement-readiness insights.
Champion	TPO / career-services leader with access to leadership and faculty.
Employer partner	A small set of recruiters willing to review anonymized evidence cards and give structured feedback.
Avoid initially	Institution without an operational owner, no student access, no consent/privacy process, or expectation of guaranteed placements.

3. Offer design and pilot

Offer	Suggested scope	Pilot exit criteria
Design-partner pilot	6–8 weeks; one institution, one cohort, one job family; co-designed rubric; limited employer panel.	Student activation, project completion, scorecard usefulness, recruiter relevance, consent comprehension and staff effort measured.
Institution subscription (hypothesis)	Annual license for roster, skill readiness dashboard, cohort reporting and student workflow.	Only price after pilot value and support burden are measured.
Employer access (later test)	Employer workflow for jobs, anonymized candidate discovery and consent-based reveal.	Validate candidate quality and willingness to pay; do not charge for access to student identity without clear terms.

4. Acquisition channels

Channel	Execution	Leading metric
Founder-led institutional outreach	Targeted email/LinkedIn outreach to TPOs and employability leaders; use a concise problem hypothesis and pilot offer.	Qualified discovery calls / target accounts contacted.
Department and faculty champions	Run one job-family workshop and select a project rubric with faculty.	Champion conversion and student opt-in.
Employer design partners	Invite recruiters to blind-review sample cards and define what evidence they trust.	Recruiter participation and evidence usefulness rating.
Webinars / placement workshops	Teach project-to-evidence portfolios, assessment transparency and placement readiness.	Registrations-to-pilot conversations.
Student community	Share examples of project evidence, skill gap feedback and privacy controls; avoid promising jobs.	Activation, completion and referral rate.
Partner referrals	Use university groups, alumni networks, professional associations and placement communities.	Introductions, sales-cycle length and pilot conversion.

5. Messaging framework

Audience	Core message	Proof required
University	Make student skills visible and turn evidence into actionable readiness insights.	Pilot metrics, staff workload, data controls, cohort reports.
Student	Build a credible evidence-backed profile and control when identity is shared.	Transparent rubric, working privacy controls, useful feedback and accessible appeal.
Employer	Review relevant, anonymized candidates with evidence-linked match reasons.	Blind review results, shortlist relevance and screening-time comparison.

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6. Funnel and metrics

Stage	Measure	Decision use
Target accounts	Accounts researched, contacts reached, reply rate	Whether ICP and messaging are correct.
Discovery	Qualified calls, repeated pain points, budget owner identified	Whether the problem is urgent and purchaseable.
Pilot proposal	Proposals, time to decision, objections	Procurement friction and offer clarity.
Pilot activation	Institution kickoff, roster import success, student opt-in	Onboarding feasibility.
Engagement	Project starts/completions, scorecard review, return visits	Student workflow value.
Employer value	Blind card review, relevance rating, access request, interview conversion	Signal quality and marketplace liquidity.
Commercial conversion	Pilot-to-paid, ACV, sales cycle, renewal intent	Repeatable business model.
Trust	Consent comprehension, complaints, appeals, withdrawals, unauthorized denials	Safety and confidence.

7. First 90 days — milestone plan

Window	Actions	Deliverable
Days 1–15	Recruit 10–15 institutional discovery interviews and 5–8 recruiter interviews; map current workflows and buying roles.	Interview synthesis, ranked pains, buying-process map.
Days 16–30	Run student usability sessions; prototype one role-specific evidence rubric; test privacy/consent comprehension.	Revised prototype, rubric v1, risk register.
Days 31–60	Secure 1–2 design partners; run a small cohort pilot with synthetic or consented data; recruit employer reviewers.	Pilot agreement, baseline metrics, cohort plan.
Days 61–90	Measure completion, scorecard trust, recruiter relevance, staff effort and willingness to pay; decide continue/pivot.	Pilot report, price-test evidence, go/no-go recommendation.

8. GTM risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Slow institutional procurement	Begin with a scoped pilot, identify economic buyer early and document data/security needs.
Cold-start marketplace	Concentrate on one job family and one or two institution cohorts; pre-recruit employers.
Low student completion	Co-design workflow, keep tasks bounded, show immediate feedback and reduce duplicate data entry.
Distrust of AI scores	Publish rubric, evidence references, confidence, appeal process and human-review boundaries.
No proof of ROI	Measure baseline and pilot outcomes; avoid placement guarantees or unsupported impact claims.
Privacy / security concerns	Consent-first disclosure, least-privilege access, RLS tests, clear retention and escalation process.

9. Pricing experiments

• Interview institutions about current spend, procurement threshold, budget owner and alternative tools before proposing a fixed price.

• Test a paid pilot versus a no-cost design partnership with explicit time limits and success criteria.

• Compare annual institution license, per-active-student pricing and cohort-based pricing; do not commit until willingness-to-pay evidence exists.

• Keep employer-side monetization as a separate experiment; avoid charging both sides for the same value without clarity.

10. Positioning statement

For universities that want stronger evidence of student readiness, AptoHire turns project work into explainable skill profiles and cohort insights, while enabling employers to explore anonymized candidates and request identity only with student consent.

11. Source and assumption note

This GTM plan is a proposed strategy based on AptoHire’s stated institution-first priority and intended product capabilities. It is not evidence of traction or validated demand. Macro context: AISHE reports from the Ministry of Education; Mercer’s India Graduate Skill Index 2025; Azim Premji University’s State of Working India 2026. Competitor context: official Unstop overview and vendor pages. Validate all commercial assumptions in discovery.